Valkyries Win and Celebrate With a Parade

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The Golden State Valkyries are the new WNBA **champions**, and they celebrated in style on Wednesday. The players held a **parade** with fans in Oakland and San Francisco. They joked that fans should take the day off to join the party. The team's **mascot** is a raven named Vi, short for Violet. The celebration started at Jack London Square in Oakland. Then they took a **ferry** across the bay and **paraded** to near Oracle Park, home of the San Francisco Giants. Fans wore team colours and cheered from the street and even from a **rooftop**. The Valkyries are a new team. They were given a team only three years ago. Owner Joe Lacob said they would win a title in five years. They did it in two. In the finals, Atlanta player Angel Reese made a "too small" hand **gesture** at the Valkyries. The Valkyries turned it into a joke, and guard Juste Jocyte flashed the **gesture** to the fans at the **parade**.

Word Treasure

mascot -- A mascot is a character or animal that stands for a team.
champions -- A champion is a person or team that wins a contest.
parade -- A parade is a march through the streets to celebrate something.
ferry -- A ferry is a boat that carries people across water.
gesture -- A gesture is a movement you make with your hands to send a message.
rooftop -- A rooftop is the top of a building.

Background you need

The WNBA is the top women's basketball league in the United States.

A championship parade is a big public party where a winning team rides through a city.

A mascot is a fun character that stands for a team.

Break it down

WHO: The Golden State Valkyries players and their fans
WHAT: A championship parade to celebrate the WNBA title
WHERE: Oakland and San Francisco
WHY: The Valkyries won the championship in only their second year

Why it matters

If your team wins, you can join a parade and cheer with your friends, just like the Valkyries' fans did.

Test what you remember

1. What team just won the WNBA title?

(A) The Golden State Valkyries
(B) The San Francisco Giants
(C) The Oakland A's
(D) The Atlanta Dream

2. What is the mascot Vi?

(A) A raven
(B) A bear
(C) A lion
(D) A dog

3. How did the players cross the bay?

(A) By plane
(B) By car
(C) By train
(D) By ferry

4. How long ago was the team given to Golden State?

(A) Three years ago
(B) Five years ago
(C) Ten years ago
(D) Two years ago

5. Who made the "too small" gesture first?

(A) Juste Jocyte
(B) Angel Reese
(C) Tiffany Hayes
(D) Joe Lacob

6. What did Joe Lacob say the team would do?

(A) Move to San Francisco
(B) Win a title in two years
(C) Change its name
(D) Win a title in five years

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: D 4: A 5: B 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):